

important national data. Not only this, they must implement guidelines for government employees to make sure that the nation does not pay the price for their mistakes. A reassessment of the quality of security professionals to counter the latest techniques of cyber warfare is also needed.

A word on Open Source

The biggest advantage of Open Source is, well, openness. In most cases it is also free of cost. The open nature of open source makes sure that it is available for modification by anyone who uses it. Since the program is modifiable, special modifications can ensure security at lower levels of data access e.g. embedding security within the modules which deal with network protocols or creating a new file system (or modify an existing one) which encrypts all data before writing to disk. While these are very small examples, a lot more sophisticated methods can ensure that entire systems are protected by default and that mistakes by employees on their personal computers or office workstations do not end up opening a backdoor of any kind that leads to an information leak or interception by a third party.

Deployment of open source technologies also makes sure that an internal team could be maintained to take care of any vulnerabilities rather than depending on the software vendor to do the task. Not only this, since national infrastructure cannot be built using a handful of computers, open source can help save a lot of investments in software as well. 